



This Photo by Unknown Author is licensed under [CC BY-SA](#)

# Research Design-Part II

Lecture by: Dr. Iqra Abdullah

Book Reference: Chapter 3: Kothari, C.R, (2008). Research methodology: Methods and techniques New Delhi, New Age International Publishers

# Different Types of Research Design



## Types of Research Design

Exploratory  
Research Studies

Descriptive and  
Diagnostic  
Research Studies

Hypothesis-  
Testing Research  
Studies



# 1. Exploratory Research Studies

The main purpose of such studies is: formulating a problem for more precise investigation or of developing the working hypotheses from an operational point of view. The major emphasis in such studies is on the discovery of ideas and insights.

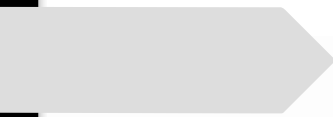
1. The survey of concerning literature
2. Experience survey
3. Analysis of 'insight-stimulating' examples

## 2. Descriptive and Diagnostic Research Studies

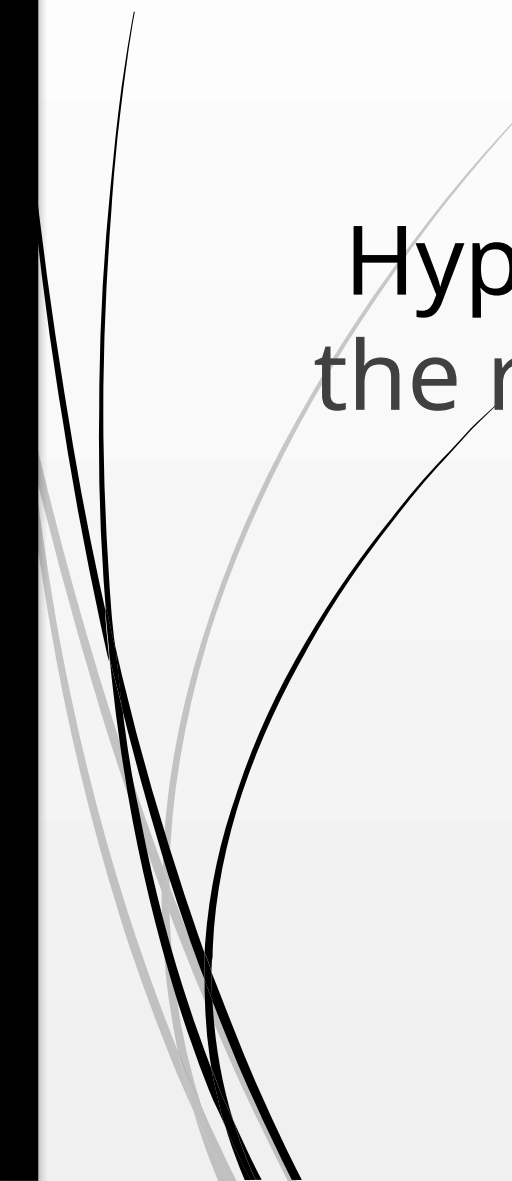
- **Descriptive Research:** those studies which are concerned with describing the characteristics of a particular individual, or of a group.
- **Diagnostic Research:** studies determine the frequency with which something occurs or its association with something else.
- The design in such studies must be rigid and not flexible and must focus attention on the following:
  - a) Formulating the objective of the study (what the study is about and why is it being made?)
  - b) Designing the methods of data collection(what techniques of gathering data will be adopted?)
  - c) Selecting the sample (how much material will be needed?)
  - d) Collecting the data(where can there required data be found and with what time period should the data be related?)
  - e) Processing and analysing the data.
  - f) Reporting the findings.

# Comparison between Descriptive/Diagnostic Research and Exploratory Research

| <i>Research Design</i>     | <i>Type of study</i>                                                                               |                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            | <i>Exploratory of Formulative</i>                                                                  | <i>Descriptive/Diagnostic</i>                                                                              |
| Overall design             | Flexible design (design must provide opportunity for considering different aspects of the problem) | Rigid design (design must make enough provision for protection against bias and must maximise reliability) |
| (i) Sampling design        | Non-probability sampling design (purposive or judgement sampling)                                  | Probability sampling design (random sampling)                                                              |
| (ii) Statistical design    | No pre-planned design for analysis                                                                 | Pre-planned design for analysis                                                                            |
| (iii) Observational design | Unstructured instruments for collection of data                                                    | Structured or well thought out instruments for collection of data                                          |
| (iv) Operational design    | No fixed decisions about the operational procedures                                                | Advanced decisions about operational procedures.                                                           |



### 3. Hypothesis-Testing Research Studies



Hypothesis-Testing Research Studies: where the researcher tests the hypotheses of causal relationships between variables.

# Class Activity

Write Examples of Exploratory, Descriptive and Diagnostic Research Studies and Prepare their Research Designs

| <i>Research Design</i>     |
|----------------------------|
| Overall design             |
| (i) Sampling design        |
| (ii) Statistical design    |
| (iii) Observational design |
| (iv) Operational design    |